



DRAFT BEER TROUBLESHOOTING CHART

POUR PROBLEMS

WHAT YOU SEE	CHECK THIS FIRST	FIX
Foamy pour	Cooler temperature, regulator pressure, and how it's poured.	Cooler at 38°F. Set pressure for the beer. Pour the way the box below shows.
First pour of the day is foam	Beer in the tower warmed up overnight.	Check tower cooling on a kegerator, or the glycol chiller on a long-draw.
New keg pours foamy	Did it arrive warm off the truck, or sit outside the cooler?	Keep it in the cooler until it's 38°F. That can take a day. Already tapped? Let it chill first. Don't raise pressure.
Beer warm at the tap (long-draw)	Is the glycol chiller running? Is the glycol full? Are tower lines cold?	Top off the glycol. If the pump or chiller stopped, call your draft installer.
Ice in the lines (long-draw)	Glycol set too cold.	Raise the glycol temperature and let the lines thaw. Call your installer if it repeats.
One tap foams, the rest pour fine	That line's length, tubing size, kinks, and faucet seals.	Match the line to the others. Replace kinked tubing and worn seals.
Flat beer	Pressure, CO ₂ tank level, beer temperature, and gas blend.	Set pressure for the beer at 38°F. Swap a low tank. Use the gas the brewery recommends.
Pressure keeps dropping	Gas leak. Close the tank, note the gauge, check again in an hour.	Spray soapy water on every gas fitting. Bubbles show the leak.
Slow pour	Kinked line, sticky faucet, low pressure, or an empty keg.	Fix the kink or the faucet. Cranking up pressure causes foam and flat beer.
No beer at all	Keg, coupler, gas valve, CO ₂ tank, FOB, and beer pump.	Tank empty? Swap in a spare or call your gas supplier. FOB or pump? See below.

FOBS AND BEER PUMPS

WHAT YOU SEE	CHECK THIS FIRST	FIX
FOB tripped and full of foam	The keg is empty.	Tap a fresh keg. Vent the FOB until beer fills it and the float rises. Close the vent and reset.
FOB trips with beer still in the keg	Low pressure, a low tank, or a dirty FOB.	Check the gas first. FOBs get cleaned every 14 days with the lines.
Beer pump runs when no one is pouring	A leak on the beer side, or a worn pump.	Look for drips at fittings. No leak? Call your installer to service the pump.
Beer pump runs, little beer comes out	Gas or air supply feeding the pump.	Check the tank or compressor that drives the pumps. Supply good? Call for service.

TASTE PROBLEMS

WHAT YOU TASTE	CHECK THIS FIRST	FIX
Vinegar or sour	Bacteria in the lines.	Full caustic cleaning. Take faucets and couplers apart and scrub them.
Buttery or butterscotch	Diacetyl. Taste the same beer from a can or bottle.	Can tastes clean: clean the lines. Can tastes buttery too: call the brewery.
Musty or moldy	Faucets and drip trays.	Pull the faucet and look inside. Wash drip trays every day.
Medicinal or Band-Aid	Chlorine left in the lines after cleaning.	Rinse the lines well with clean water before beer goes back in.
Stale or cardboard	Oxygen from a worn coupler seal, a loose fitting, or an old keg.	Replace worn seals. Check the keg date.
Skunky from the first pour	Light hit the keg before it was tapped.	Store kegs out of direct light.
Off-taste returns after cleaning	Beer stone or worn-out tubing.	Acid cleaning every 3 months. Replace vinyl lines every year.

HOW TO POUR

1. Grab the tap handle at the bottom and pull it all the way open in one move.
2. Hold a clean, cold-rinsed glass at 45°, about an inch below the faucet.
3. Never let the faucet touch the glass or the beer.
4. Tilt the glass upright as it fills. Leave about an inch of head.
5. Push the handle all the way closed.

38°F

KEG COOLER

Every 14 days

LINE CLEANING (PA LAW)

Every 3 months

ACID CLEANING

Every year

REPLACE VINYL LINES